



Operate an automated information system

D2.TTA.CL2.14
D2.TGA.CL6.06

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
 ■ You are required to complete these activities:
 a) *Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 b) *At 'X' location*
 c) *You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 ■ You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 ■ Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: OPERATE AN AUTOMATED INFORMATION SYSTEM		NOMINAL HOURS: 50
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.14 D2.TGA.CL6.06		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to process information within an automated information system to support the effective operation of a travel and tourism business		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Identify the context for use of an automated information system 1.1 Identify a range of <i>information systems and sources in use</i> within the industry 1.2 Describe <i>policies and procedures</i> for operating an automated information system 1.3 List <i>information</i> that may be available through an automated information system 1.4 Identify the <i>functions</i> of an automated information system Element 2: Access information using an automated information system 2.1 Identify <i>information requirements</i> 2.2 Identify and select appropriate sources of information 2.3 Apply <i>search techniques</i> to locate identified information		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to all industry sectors that operate an automated information system within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Tour Operation 2. Travel Agencies <i>Information systems and sources in use</i> may include: • Internet • Enterprise-specific systems designed by the host enterprise • Government travel and tourism authority and agency information systems • Industry-based systems, including local, regional, domestic and international information systems • Free-of-charge and fee-for-services information systems and databases • Computerised reservation systems.

2.4 <i>Interrogate the system</i> to secure full range of information available on the system 2.5 <i>Verify captured information</i> meets identified need Element 3: Obtain information using an automated information system 3.1 <i>Enable access</i> to required system and/or information 3.2 <i>Select required information</i> 3.3 <i>Download information</i> 3.4 <i>Print information</i> Element 4: Use information from information an automated information system 4.1 <i>Forward information</i> as required 4.2 <i>Save identified information</i> 4.3 <i>Manipulate accessed information</i> 4.4 <i>Report on findings</i> Element 5: Up-date and maintain information on an automated information system 5.1 <i>Enter data</i> onto automated information system 5.2 <i>Save and back-up data</i>	<i>Policies and procedures</i> may relate to legal, financial and host enterprise requirements which may include: • System access protocols, including levels of access, log-on and log-off protocols • Program and data change controls • Authentication of customers and users • Validation of on-line information sources • Electronic transactions legislation of the host country, where applicable • Confidentiality of customer and business data, including privacy concerns • Security and integrity of information, including building/office and premises/building security • Type and level of encryption, including use of private key infrastructure • Intellectual property rights, including security of same and guidelines regarding use • Validity of contacts and contracts initiated or established via the automated information system, including non-repudiation • Legal jurisdiction issues • International trade issues • Archiving requirements. <i>Information</i> may relate to a wide and diverse range of topics and may include: • Travel, including air, cruise, train, bus and car • Destinations, including statistical information and details relating to climate, currency, maps, travel guides, events, languages, history, safety, government information, time zones, culture and communications • Tourist activities and attractions, including natural and man-made • Tours, trips, sight-seeing and excursions
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	• Accommodation facilities ranging from five-star to back-packer venues and including, blocked dates, seasons and times, minimum purchase, use, booking and stay requirements, where applicable • Services, including medical, personal, entertainment, sporting, shopping • Travel requirements, including requirements relating to entry, passport, visas, warnings and advisory bulletins, customs information • Finance and travel insurance • Allotments of any type of tourism product, including accommodation, seats, entry passes • Rates, costs and tariffs, including details relating to specials, packages, discounts, peak and low season rates, premiums, commissions and group rates • Terms and conditions of sale, including details that apply to the business and to clients and purchasers • Booking requirements, including details required and timeline pre-requisites for advanced bookings. <i>Functions</i> should relate to: • Individual system options and functions • Data entry and retrieval • Data storage and processing • Production of hard copy information • System flags and triggers for attention and action • Basic operational system back-up procedures • Interface with other systems and operational requirements.
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	<i>Information requirements</i> may relate to: • Requests from colleagues and other associated agencies/businesses • Requests from clients, including responses to on-line requests • Clarification of existing information on the system • Specification of data that is required. <i>Apply search techniques</i> and interrogating the system may include: • Using search engines, including advanced search features and search engines specific to identified fields of information/knowledge • Using appropriate key words • Investigating indices, catalogues and directories provided by search engines • Using confidence and relevancy ranking, where appropriate • Querying and/or refining searches • Using internal website search engines • Using boolean search techniques • Using multiple or meta search tools within a range of key words • Using domain name searches • Using database search functions • Following relevant links • Retrieving required information • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements. <i>Interrogate the system</i> may include: • Accessing necessary screens and fields related to the search topic
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	• Using designated access protocols at differing levels of authorisation, including passwords and access codes • Searching fields • Opening screen options, including links, drop-down menus and related files and folders • Conducting searches • Referring to the operations manual to identify advanced interrogation techniques. <i>Verify captured information</i> may include: • Checking with person who made the request for information • Comparing request criteria with information that has been sourced and obtained • Checking currency of the data • Verifying the source of the data, including assessing reputation and credibility of information provider • Conducting follow-up searches and research as necessary • Complying with host enterprise requirements. <i>Enable access</i> may include: • Obtaining internal authority to register with, or access, a site or system • Making payment or placing order, where required, to access a user-pays system • Registering host enterprise details with information provider • Submitting access codes, information and data to enable access by others, including details relating to various access levels, where applicable • Issuing authorities for staff to access sites and files, including details relating to various access levels, where applicable • Book-marking relevant sites • Complying with host enterprise requirements.
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	<i>Select required information</i> relates to: • Considering available sources of potential information • Determining and interrogating appropriate sources • Choosing best option data to meet identified need. <i>Download information</i> may include: • Saving data to files and folders • Producing hard copy material • Enabling on-screen visual access without saving data • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements. <i>Print information</i> refers to: • The production of information in hard copy form. <i>Forward information</i> may include: • Sending files to linked computers and/or systems • Distributing hard copy information, including distribution to internal colleagues and external businesses and clients • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements. <i>Save identified information</i> may include: • Saving electronic files to nominated folders and files • Saving hard copy data to paper-based files • Maintaining version control • Recording data source.
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	<i>Manipulate accessed information</i> may include: • Performing calculations to determine options • Processing data to generate optimal solutions • Integrating data into databases • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements. <i>Report on findings</i> may include: • Supplying electronic, verbal or hard copy suggestions, recommendations and findings to: ▪ Management ▪ Colleagues ▪ Businesses ▪ Clients. <i>Enter data</i> refers to uploading information to the host enterprise system and must include: • Entering data in a timely manner • Ensuring accuracy and completeness of data within files and fields • Ensuring all files and fields are completed as required • Integrating data with other information, as required • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements. <i>Save and back-up data</i> may include: • Complying with relevant schedules • Archiving material • Storing data off-site • Completing documentation to support data saving and back-up • Complying with system and host enterprise requirements.
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	Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to generation, manipulation, sharing, and protection of and access to data on an internal automated information system • Principles of operation of automated information systems • Principles governing copyright, use of intellectual property, privacy and confidentiality legislation of the host country • Ability to use internet search and database interrogation techniques • Ability to demonstrate basic keyboarding skills • Ability to demonstrate electronic file handling capabilities, including file creation, file naming and re-naming, saving, copying, editing and printing. Linkages To Other Units • Access and interpret product information • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Use common business tools and technology • Operate a computerised reservation system • Source and provide destination information and advice • Maintain product information inventory. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of the role of the automated information system within the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to create files and folders for nominated new information on a designated automated information system
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	• Demonstrated ability to access and retrieve nominated information from a designated automated information system and present that information in nominated electronic and hard copy format • Demonstrated ability to save electronic versions of nominated information from a designated automated information system and forward that information to a selected in-house computer • Demonstrated ability to input nominated data into appropriate electronic files, fields and/or folders on a designated automated information system • Demonstrated ability to perform basic daily/weekly back-up procedures for a designated automated information system. Context of Assessment Assessment must ensure: • Actual or simulated workplace to be able to demonstrate the application of techniques to operate an automated information system. Resource Implications Training and assessment must include the use of real equipment, databases, facilities, product information and systems in real or simulated workplace conditions. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Portfolio of hard copy documentation generated as a result of the operation of an automated information system • Simulated practical exercises • Role plays • Oral and written questions
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	• Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	1	Determining information to be captured; evaluating and verifying system data from outside sources
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Preparing retrieved information for presentation to those who requested it
	Planning and organising activities	1	Scheduling system back-ups; determining files, folders and locations for system information
	Working with others and in teams	1	Cooperating with other in the retrieving and loading of system information
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculating costs to enable best match of data to meet identified client need
	Solving problems	1	Conductive alternative on-line searches to secure missing and/or follow-up information
	Using technology	1	Using the internet and the host enterprise automated information system

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Operate an automated information system D2.TTA.CL2.14 D2.TGA.CL6.06
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Identify a range of information systems used within the Tourism industry.	☐	☐
2. Describe some key procedures for operating an automated information system.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Identify types of information you could find in an automated information system.	☐	☐
4. Explain some of the key functions of an automated information system.	☐	☐
5. What information requirements might you solicit from your client so that you can provide suitable suggestions?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. Explain how you would identify and select the most appropriate sources of information.	☐	☐
7. When interrogating the system how would you do about conducting a search of data?	☐	☐
8. Explain how you would confirm information sourced meets the client requirements.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. When making payment on-line what should you consider from a security aspect?	☐	☐
10. In what ways can you interrogate sources to find potential information?	☐	☐
11. Explain what you may need to consider before downloading data and files.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Printing bears a high cost, particularly colour print jobs. How can you minimise the possibility of incorrect printouts?	☐	☐
13. Explain why companies may have policies regarding the forwarding of electronic file to clients.	☐	☐
14. Explain what needs to be taken into consideration when saving files to shared computer libraries.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Why might you need to manipulate accessed information?	☐	☐
16. The reporting of findings may be required for whom?	☐	☐
17. What types of data may you be required to enter onto an automated information system?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. Why is it necessary to archive files and documents?	☐	☐

Written questions

Operate an automated information system – D2.TTA.CL2.14
D2.TGA.CL6.06

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. Identify the following:

CRS

GDS

2. Identify two internationally recognised automated information systems.

3. Provide three types of social media and an example of its most popular form.

4. What should you consider before using or posting copyright material?

5. Identify types of third parties tourism agents may deal with daily.

6. Identify three key functions from Galileo CRS.

7. How can you identify a hyperlink when using the internet?

8. What is meant by 'qualifying what the customer wants'?

9. What type of information may be sourced from a tourism authority?

10. What automated information may be available to employees of an organisation via their intranet?

11. What are identified as the top five search engines?

12. Why should you avoid using a question as a query in a search engine?

13. How can you focus a search when too many results are returned? (List three)

14. What search engine functions can be added to queries?

15. When navigating a website what can you do to maximise your screen?

16. How does job role have an impact when providing information to clients?

17. What information may be purchased for your organisation? (List three)

18. How can you determine if you are on a secure website when using supplying payment details on a website?

19. What is a preferred supplier'?

20. What type of files may put your computer at most risk of viruses when downloading?

21. What should you keep in mind when downloading internet material?

22. What should you consider before printing material?

23. What should you consider before forwarding information to your client?

24. Once you have saved your document the first time and you continue adding material or making changes how do you save those changes?

25. When might information be captured and recorded for data bases? (List three)

26. Does Excel allow you to sort more than one field when manipulating data?

27. Why might you be required to report findings to management?

28. Operators are expected to be able to perform what three sequences for processing tasks when working with data?

29. In order to complete word processing tasks effectively operators are expected to be competent with what other applications? (List three)

30. How can you ensure an efficient filing system?

31. What methods can be used for labelling files when archiving?

Answers to written questions

Operate an automated information system – D2.TTA.CL2.14
D2.TGA.CL6.06

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. Identify the following:

CRS

GDS

The Central Reservation System (CRS) also known as a Global Distribution System (GDS).

2. Identify two internationally recognised automated information systems.

There are a few internationally recognised tourism industry systems e.g. Galileo by Travelport, Amadeus or Sabre.

3. Provide three types of social media and an example of its most popular form.

Social media includes, but is not limited to:

- Social networking sites (e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn)
- Video and photo sharing websites (e.g. Flickr, YouTube)
- Blogs, including corporate blogs and personal blogs
- Micro-blogging (e.g. Twitter)
- Forums, discussion boards and groups (e.g. Google groups, Whirlpool).

4. What should you consider before using or posting copyright material?

Make sure you have permission to post copyright items, properly attribute the work to the copyright owner where required, and never use someone else's work as if it were your own.

5. Identify types of third parties tourism agents may deal with daily.

- Tour operators
- Wholesalers
- Tourism authorities.

6. Identify three key functions from Galileo CRS.

- Flight availability
- Selling flights
- Booking file creation
- Passenger servicing
- Fares
- Booking file support
- Other services
- Car reservations
- Hotel reservations.

7. How can you identify a hyperlink when using the internet?

Most are coloured blue and are underlined (like the web addresses on the proceeding page). However, sometimes it is hard to identify them, so a second method is useful. If you hover your cursor or icon and it changes to a small hand with the pointer finger pointing, then that is most likely a hyperlink.

8. What is meant by ‘qualifying what the customer wants’?

Asking and probing for more and more information until a more detailed profile of the customer’s needs, and possible solutions for meeting them, begin to form in our minds.

9. What type of information may be sourced from a tourism authority?

The type of information that they can provide would include:

- Maps
- Destination and city guides
- Festivals and events
- Suggested itineraries
- Photo galleries.

10. What automated information may be available to employees of an organisation via their intranet?

- Staff Directory
- Policies & Procedures
- Forms & Documents
- Different departments.

11. What are identified as the top five search engines?

- Google
- Bing
- Yahoo! Search
- Ask
- Aol Search.

12. Why should you avoid using a question as a query in a search engine?

Such a query won't necessarily find pages answering your question.

13. How can you focus a search when too many results are returned? (List three)

- Adding a word or phrase
- Specifying the order in which you want words to appear
- Using a more specific term
- Identifying ineffective terms and removing them
- Limiting a date range
- Limiting where terms occur
- Limiting the page to a particular country.

14. What search engine functions can be added to queries?

- + Search
- OR Search
- Numrange Search
- Fill in the Blanks Search.

15. When navigating a website what can you do to maximise your screen?

Clicking the F11 function button on your keyboard will remove the toolbars and maximise your screen.

16. How does job role have an impact when providing information to clients?

If you are working at a visitor information centre or an agency specialising in a particular product or destination, you may be required to provide a much greater depth of general information. If you are working in a travel agency selling worldwide destinations, the destination information you provide may be fairly general.

17. What information may be purchased for your organisation? (List three)

- Maps and posters
- Brochures
- Guide books
- Timetables
- Information pamphlets
- Baggage tags and ticket wallets.

18. How can you determine if you are on a secure website when using supplying payment details on a website?

- Look for the picture of the unbroken key or closed lock in a corner of your browser window
- Look to see if the web address on the page that asks for your credit card information begins with 'https:' instead of 'http'
- Some web sites use the words 'Secure Sockets Layer (SSL)' or a pop up box that says you are entering a secure area.

19. What is a preferred supplier'?

These are suppliers with whom your organisation has an established relationship and you can confidently access information and sell products from these companies.

20. What type of files may put your computer at most risk of viruses when downloading?

The formats that may place the computer you are working on at most risk are Word, PowerPoint and Excel files, as these can carry viruses more readily than Web pages and PDF files.

21. What should you keep in mind when downloading internet material?

Some things you should keep in mind about the time it will take you to download it, how to save it, and the copyright ownership of the material.

22. What should you consider before printing material?

When printing or downloading from your automated system, it is critical to follow the company procedure of your employer. Many enterprises will have standard written, or at least verbal, directions on what is acceptable to purchase or print for your organisation and customers.

23. What should you consider before forwarding information to your client?

You need to ensure they understand why you are emailing this information to them.

24. Once you have saved your document the first time and you continue adding material or making changes how do you save those changes?

Now that you have saved your file the first time, you have created a “pathway” and whenever you have the file open in Word, it remembers that pathway. **To save the file in progress, while you are working on it, simply locate the icon on the toolbar that looks like a small computer disk and single left click on the icon.** This will save the file again over the original file in the same pathway.

25. When might information be captured and recorded for data bases? (List three)

Any of the following:

Customer information and details may need to be recorded when customers:

- Register as a customer
- Register for a loyalty scheme
- Lodge a request for further information about a product/service
- Seek a quote
- Request to be added to an internal database
- Return a product for some reason
- Make a complaint.

26. Does Excel allow you to sort more than one field when manipulating data?

Microsoft Excel allows you to sort more than one field. For example, suppose you wish to sort the database in Position order first, then Last Name order for records having the same Position. In this example, two sort keys would have to be nominated. Microsoft Excel allows you to nominate up to three sort keys for operation.

27. Why might you be required to report findings to management?

You might have been asked to develop a possible solution to an existing problem. For example, you might be required to recommend a more efficient system for work procedures and reduce costs, or to find ways of increasing client interest in the company’s products and services.

28. Operators are expected to be able to perform what three sequences for processing tasks when working with data?

- Retrieve, view and close a word document;
- Create, save and print a word processing document
- Retrieve, amend, save and print a word document.

29. In order to complete word processing tasks effectively operators are expected to be competent with what other applications? (List three)

Directories, sub directories and folders	Menus and prompts
Records and fields	Default settings
Log-in/log-out protocols	Error correction
Proofreading	Keying techniques
Spellcheck and thesaurus	Screen sizing
Accessing recent records	Copying to thumbdrive / pendrive / USB
Deleting files	Fonts and font size

30. How can you ensure an efficient filing system?

To ensure an efficient filing system you will need to;

- Label documents in an easily recognisable and logical manner
- File documents to folders
- Always back up your files.

31. What methods can be used for labelling files when archiving?

- By year
 - Department
 - Subject
 - Numerically
 - Alphabetically
 - Chronologically
 - Geographically.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Operate an automated information system D2.TTA.CL2.14 D2.TGA.CL6.06
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Identify the context for use of an automated information system - Access information using an automated information system - Obtain information using an automated information system - Use information from information an automated information system - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Identify the context for use of an automated information system		
Identify a range of information systems and sources in use within the industry	☐	☐
Describe policies and procedures for operating an automated information system	☐	☐
List information that may be available through an automated information system	☐	☐
Identify the functions of an automated information system	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Access information using an automated information system		
Identify information requirements	☐	☐
Identify and select appropriate sources of information	☐	☐
Apply search techniques to locate identified information	☐	☐
Interrogate the system to secure full range of information available on the system	☐	☐
Verify captured information meets identified need	☐	☐
Element 3: Obtain information using an automated information system		
Enable access to required system and/or information	☐	☐
Select required information	☐	☐
Download information	☐	☐
Print information	☐	☐
Element 4: Use information from information an automated information system		
Forward information as required	☐	☐
Save identified information	☐	☐
Manipulate accessed information	☐	☐
Report on findings	☐	☐
Element 5: Up-date and maintain information on an automated information system		
Enter data onto automated information system	☐	☐
Save and back-up data	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Operate an automated information system D2.TTA.CL2.14 D2.TGA.CL6.06		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Identify the context for use of an automated information system			
Identifies a range of information systems and sources in use within the industry	☐	☐	☐
Describes policies and procedures for operating an automated information system	☐	☐	☐
Lists information that may be available through an automated information system	☐	☐	☐
Identifies the functions of an automated information system	☐	☐	☐
Element 2: Access information using an automated information system			
Identifies information requirements	☐	☐	☐
Identifies and select appropriate sources of information	☐	☐	☐
Applies search techniques to locate identified information	☐	☐	☐

Interrogates the system to secure full range of information available on the system	☐	☐	☐
Verifies captured information meets identified need	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Obtain information using an automated information system			
Enables access to required system and/or information	☐	☐	☐
Selects required information	☐	☐	☐
Downloads information	☐	☐	☐
Prints information	☐	☐	☐
Element 4: Use information from information an automated information system			
Forwards information as required	☐	☐	☐
Saves identified information	☐	☐	☐
Manipulates accessed information	☐	☐	☐
Reports on findings	☐	☐	☐
Element 5: Up-date and maintain information on an automated information system			
Enters data onto automated information system	☐	☐	☐
Saves and back-up data	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Operate an automated information system	D2.TTA.CL2.14 D2.TGA.CL6.06
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Identify the context for use of an automated information system						
Identify a range of information systems and sources in use within the industry						
Describe policies and procedures for operating an automated information system						
List information that may be available through an automated information system						
Identify the functions of an automated information system						
Element 2: Access information using an automated information system						
Identify information requirements						
Identify and select appropriate sources of information						
Apply search techniques to locate identified information						
Interrogate the system to secure full range of information available on the system						
Verify captured information meets identified need						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Obtain information using an automated information system						
Enable access to required system and/or information						
Select required information						
Download information						
Print information						
Element 4: Use information from information an automated information system						
Forward information as required						
Save identified information						
Manipulate accessed information						
Report on findings						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria		Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 5: Up-date and maintain information on an automated information system							
Enter data onto automated information system							
Save and back-up data							
Candidate signature:				Date:			
Assessor signature:				Date:			

